# /cancel

Cancel a background task (/cancel | /cancel help)

## Overview

`/cancel` cancels a running background task by ID prefix. It matches against two registries: the active benchmark task (cancelling it raises the bench cancel flag and asks the benchmark loop to stop cooperatively) and the active sub-agent task list (the matched entry is removed from the list immediately).

A prefix match is used, so a short unique ID prefix is enough - the command finds the first task whose ID starts with the given prefix. `/cancel help` prints the subcommand table; an empty argument is a usage error.

## Syntax

```
/cancel <task_id_prefix>
/cancel help
```

## Options / Subcommands

| Form | Description |
|---|---|
| `/cancel <task_id_prefix>` | Cancel a running background task or benchmark by ID prefix |
| `/cancel help` | Show the `/cancel` help table |

Notes:

- Benchmark tasks: when the prefix matches `active_bench_task_id`, the bench cancellation flag is set and the status bar shows a wait marker; the benchmark stops between steps, not mid-step.
- Sub-agent tasks: the first `active_tasks` entry whose ID starts with the prefix is removed from the list.
- Prefix matching is `starts_with` on the raw ID; no case folding.

## Examples

`/cancel a1b2c3`

`/cancel bench`

Cancel a benchmark (status bar):

`bench: cancellation requested`

Cancel a sub-agent task (status bar shows first 8 ID chars):

`Cancelled task a1b2c3d4 (coder)`

`/cancel help`

Missing argument (status bar + warn log):

`[warn] Please provide a task ID prefix: /cancel <id>`

No match:

`No task found with ID starting with 'zz'`

## Output

- On benchmark cancel: status bar `bench: cancellation requested`, Info log `Benchmark cancellation requested for <prefix>`.
- On task cancel: status bar `Cancelled task <8-char id> (<agent>)`, Info log `Task cancelled: <8-char id>... (<agent>)`, and the entry is removed from the active task list.
- On no match: status bar `No task found with ID starting with '<prefix>'` plus a Warn log entry.
- `/cancel help` appends an assistant bubble `From: /cancel help` with the subcommand table; status shows `cancel: help`.

## Related

- `/bench` - run benchmarks that produce the cancellable bench task
- Background sub-agents are spawned with `new_agent` and listed in the task UI
- `/help` - list all available slash commands